



UCS503 EmPay SATURN5

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Introduction

Overview: Digital payments depend on continuous network connectivity to verify payers, authenticate transactions, and prevent double spending.

Importance: In situations such as network outages, crowded areas, or emergencies, users need to transfer payments locally. Bluetooth allows device-to-device communication in these scenarios.

Presentation Objectives: Evaluate protocol security, trace failure modes, and formally prove transaction invariants under explicit trust assumptions, specifically addressing double spending, replay attacks, cloned/rolled-back device states, and interrupted transfers.

Project Scope

Project Aims: Design, simulate, and verify EmPay - an offline-payment protocol simulator and adversarial verification platform to test and secure local transaction exchanges.

Deliverables: Build simulated offline payment components (issuer, payer, merchant) to trace failure modes and evaluate protocol security under explicit trust assumptions.

Functionality: Provide a simulation tool to model and test system robustness against double-spending, replay attacks, cloned device states, local rollback, and partial Bluetooth exchanges.

Proposed Functions

Major Functions: Simulated bank/issuer tracks transactions, including user balances, offline allocations, and device states.

User Needs: Handles user balance allocations (e.g., User balance: ₹30,000, offline allocation: ₹10,000, Device A: ₹6,000, Device B: ₹4,000).

Visualization: Simplifies ledger simulation by demonstrating device registration, revocation, transaction reconciliation, and authoritative settlement.

Target Users

Audience Description: Banks, small business owners, common people and organizations exploring secure offline digital payments.

User Characteristics: Small business owners and common people who need secure, reliable digital payments during limited or unavailable internet connectivity.

User Needs Impact: Enables secure offline payment transfers during network disruptions while reducing risks of double spending, replay attacks, and transaction loss.

System Features

Feature List: Android Merchant Application discovers nearby payers, receives transaction packets over Bluetooth, and displays transaction state.

Functionality Details: Verifies cryptographic signatures, checks transaction IDs , and detects duplicate or replayed messages.

Interfaces

Hardware/Software Interfaces: Bluetooth module

Communication Interfaces: Handles failure and recovery transitions through dedicated states: ABORTED, EXPIRED, RECOVERY, and REJECTED.

Performance Goals

Requirements: Uses asymmetric key pairs, digital signatures, nonces, and unique IDs to guarantee payment authenticity and integrity.

Importance: Leverages Android Keystore to manage keys, testing and comparing Software-backed, TEE-backed, and StrongBox-backed storage.

Achievement Strategies: Integrates user PIN verification with hardware-backed signing to prevent unauthorized local spending.

Security Measures

Security Overview: Systematically attacks the protocol using replay attacks, cloned states, rollback attempts, concurrent spending, and partial transfers.

Data Protection: Simulates merchant replay, duplicate messages, lost devices, and interrupted reconciliation to test protocol resilience.

Access Control: Clearly identifies which attacks are detected, documents required trust assumptions, and ensures no protocol invariant is violated.

Quality Attributes

Reliability: Represents the payment protocol as a formal state machine using TLA+/TLC model checker to verify critical properties.

Usability: Ensures that spent amount $\leq$ allocated, no double-settlement, invalid signatures are rejected, and nonces cannot be reused.

Maintainability: Proves that interrupted transactions reach a recoverable state and reconciliation cannot manufacture artificial value.

Initial Planning

Gantt Chart: Displays a real-time protocol trace including step-by-step transaction timestamps (Initiated, Connected, Verified, Settled) in a hosted web dashboard.

Feasibility Report: Tracks success rates, average sync times, and performance under simulated network delays and high concurrency.

Milestones: Provides detailed error reasons for aborted, expired, or rejected transactions to simplify system debugging and validation.

Conclusion

Summary: Design, simulate, formally verify, and adversarially test an offline Bluetooth payment protocol.

Next Steps: Demonstrate a robust solution for offline allocation, double-spend prevention, failure recovery, and reconciliation.

Feedback Invitation: Provide a clear, documented framework outlining the exact trust boundaries and hardware security levels (TEE, StrongBox) required.

References

Sources: Academic research on secure offline transactions, TLA+/TLC model checking documentation, and Android Keystore (TEE/StrongBox) APIs.